Condition-A Reconstruction in Gitksan

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Roadmap

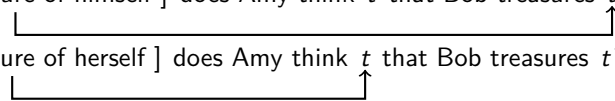
- Binding Condition A and Reconstruction
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Binding Condition A and Reconstruction

- Binding Condition A
  - (1) An anaphor must be A-bound in its local domain.
  - (2) α A-binds β iff α c-commands β, α and β are co-indexed, and α is in an A-position.

- Condition A Reconstruction
  - A-bar moved containers of anaphora may reconstruct back to their base or intermediate positions for evaluation of binding conditions.
  - [Which picture of himself] does Amy think t that Bob treasures t?

    [Which picture of herself] does Amy think t that Bob treasures t?



Research Questions

(1) Is *lip'nit* an anaphor subject to Condition A?

(2) Is *lip'nit* binding determined by c-command or by linear precedence (cf. Hunt 1993)?

(3) Do A-bar-moved phrases containing *lip'nit* reconstruct, and if so, to which trace/copy?

Methodology

- **Elicitation** with one Gitksan speaker (Vincent)
  - Stimuli adapted from the binding and reconstruction literature
  - **Translation task**: English → Gitksan
- **Interpretation judgments**
  - Questions about the referent of *lip'nit*, e.g. 'Whose photo is it?', 'Could it be John's photo?'
  - Antecedents are probed one at a time, so each reading (i / j) is tested separately
- **Minimal pairs**
  - Sentences are varied one factor at a time (word order, which argument is the subject or is inside a PP, *in situ* vs. fronted), and judgments are collected again

A-binding: Subject Binding DO

- **A-binding in PP Ditransitives: Photo Sentences**

  (a) Gina'm-i-s **John$_i$**-hl guksk'altamtux e-hl lip'nit$_{\{ i / *j \}}$ e-s
  Give-TR[-3.II]-PN John$_i$=CN photo PREP=CN SELF-3.SG.III$_{\{ i / *j \}}$ PREP=PN
  Sarah$_j$.
  Sarah$_j$.
  'John gave a photo of himself to Sarah.'

  (b) Gina'm-i-s **John$_i$** e-s **Sarah$_j$**-hl guksk'altamtux e-hl
  Give-TR[-3.II]-PN John$_i$ PREP=PN Sarah$_j$=CN photo PREP=CN
  lip'nit$_{\{ i / *j \}}$.
  SELF-3.SG.III$_{\{ i / *j \}}$.
  'John gave (to) Sarah a photo of himself.'

  (c) Gina'm-i-s **Sarah$_j$**-hl guksk'altamtux e-hl lip'nit$_{\{ *i / j \}}$ e-s **John$_i$**.
  Give-TR[-3.II]-PN Sarah$_j$=CN photo of=CN SELF-3.SG.III$_{\{ *i / j \}}$ to=PR John$_i$.
  'Sarah gave a photo of herself to John.'

- A-binding is only available for the subject; the oblique argument cannot bind the anaphor in the DO (even precedes).

A-binding: Subj/DO Binding into Oblique

- **A-binding into Oblique Objects: Mirror Sentences**
  (d) Gun-ga'a-d-i-s **John$_i$**'t **Sarah$_j$** e-hl lip'nit$_{\{ i / j \}}$ t'sim enksulakaltxw.
  CAUSE-see-T-TR=PN John=PN Sarah PREP=CN SELF-3.SG.III in mirror.
  'John showed Sarah to {her/him}-self in the mirror.'

- DO can A-bind *lip'nit* in the oblique object.
- Subject argument can also A-bind *lip'nit* in the OO.
- ☞ C-command $\rightleftharpoons$ A-bining
  Not inherently subject oriented.

A-bar Movement and Condition A Reconstruction

(1) **Reconstructing focus movement**

(a) [Guksk'altamtxw tun e-hl lip'nit$_{\{ \text{i} / *\text{j} \}}$]$_{\text{FOC}}$ gina'm-i-s **John$_{\text{i}}$** e-s **Sarah$_{\text{j}}$**.
[photo DEM PREP=CN SELF-3.SG.III$_{\{ \text{i} / *\text{j} \}}$]$_{\text{FOC}}$ give-TR[-3.II]-PN John$_{\text{i}}$ PREP=PN Sarah$_{\text{j}}$.
'It is this photo of himself that John gave to Sarah.'

(b) [Guksk'altamtxw tun e-hl lip'nit$_{\{ *\text{i} / \text{j} \}}$]$_{\text{FOC}}$ gina'm-i-s **Sarah$_{\text{j}}$** e-s **John$_{\text{i}}$**.
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'It is this photo of herself that Sarah gave to John.'

(2) **Reconstructing *wh*-movement**

(a) [Guu-hl guksk'altamtux e-hl lip'nit$_{\{ \text{i} / *\text{j} \}}$]$_{\text{WH}}$ gina'm-i-s **John$_{\text{i}}$** e-s **Sarah$_{\text{j}}$**.
[what=CN photo PREP=CN SELF-3.SG.III$_{\{ \text{i} / *\text{j} \}}$]$_{\text{WH}}$ give-TR[-3.II]-PN John$_{\text{i}}$ PREP=PN Sarah$_{\text{j}}$.
'Which photo of himself did John give to Sarah?'

(b) [Guu-hl guksk'altamtux e-hl lip'nit$_{\{ *\text{i} / \text{j} \}}$]$_{\text{WH}}$ gina'm-i-s **Sarah$_{\text{j}}$** e-s **John$_{\text{i}}$**.
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'Which photo of herself did Sarah give to John?'

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'It is this photo of herself that Sarah gave to John.'

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'Which photo of himself did John give to Sarah?'

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[what=CN photo PREP=CN SELF-3.SG.III$_{\{ *\text{i} / \text{j} \}}$]$_{\text{WH}}$ give-TR[-3.II]-PN Sarah$_{\text{j}}$ PREP=PN John$_{\text{i}}$.
'Which photo of herself did Sarah give to John?'

- A-bar-moved phrases behave like their in-situ counterparts: *lip'nit* is bound by the subject and only the subject.

☞ Proposal: this is due to reconstruction.

Interim Summary

- **Who can bind *lip'nit*?**
  - The **subject** can bind *lip'nit* in the DO and OO.
  - A bare DO can bind *lip'nit* inside OO (mirror sentences).
  - A DP embedded in a PP (*e-* oblique) **cannot** bind *lip'nit*, even when it precedes.
- **Structure, not linear order**
  - Preceding *lip'nit* is not enough to A-bind it.
  - more consistent with c-command: a PP-embedded DP does not c-command out of the PP.
- **A-bar movement**
  - Focus- and *wh*-moved phrases containing *lip'nit* pattern like their in-situ counterparts: bound by the subject, and only the subject.
  - In the surface position, the subject neither precedes nor c-commands *lip'nit*.

☞ In simple clauses, *lip'nit* behaves like a Condition A anaphor, and A-bar-moved phrases containing it **reconstruct**.

☞ Next: Complex Clauses.

Local Domain

- A-binding is restricted to local domain (a finite TP containing a subject):
  - Amgood-i-s **John$_i$**(-hl) anoga-s **Sarah$_j$**(-s) **[**Guksk'altamtxw tun
    remember-TR[-3.II]=PN John$_i$ like=PN Sarah$_j$=PN [photo DEM
    e-lh lip'nit$_{\{ *i / j \}}$**]**.
    PREP=CN SELF-3.SG.III$_{\{ *i / j \}}$].
    'John remembers that Sarah likes this photo of { *himself / herself }.'

Complexities: Long-Distance Movement

- Long-distance A-bar movement out of an embedded CP is often argued to be **successive-cyclic**: it leaves an intermediate copy at the edge of each CP it crosses.
- In principle, a moved phrase can reconstruct to *any* of these copies, so an anaphor inside it can be bound by either the matrix or the embedded subject.
- This is what we find in English:
  - [Which picture of **himself$_i$**] does Amy think t that **Bob$_i$** treasures t? (base copy)
  - [Which picture of **herself$_j$**] does **Amy$_j$** think t that Bob treasures t? (intermediate)

Complexities: Long-Distance Movement (?) in Gitksan

- In Gitksan, a focused phrase containing *lip'nit* can only be bound by the **matrix subject**, whether it is fronted in the matrix clause (a) or in the embedded clause (b).

(a) **[**Guksk'altamtxw tun e-hl lip'nit$_{\mathbf{i/*j}}$**]**$_{\text{FOC}}$ am-goodi-s **John$_{\mathbf{i}}$**(-hl) anoga-s **Sarah$_{\mathbf{j}}$**.
[photo DEM PREP=CN SELF-3.SG.III]$_{\text{FOC}}$ remember-TR[-3.II]=PN John(=CN) like-PN Sarah.

'It is this photo of {himself / *herself} that John remembers that Sarah likes.'

(b) Am-goodi-s **John$_{\mathbf{i}}$**(-hl) **[**Guksk'altamtxw tun e-hl lip'nit$_{\mathbf{i/*j}}$**]**$_{\text{FOC}}$ anoga-s **Sarah$_{\mathbf{j}}$**.
remember-TR[-3.II]=PN John(=CN) [photo DEM PREP=CN SELF-3.SG.III]$_{\text{FOC}}$ like-PN Sarah.

'John remembers that it is this photo of {himself / *herself} that Sarah likes.'

- This is unexpected;
- but further evidence suggests that the 'subordinate clause' might in fact be nominal.

Complexities: Long-Distance Movement (?) in Gitksan

- **Optional Spell-out of Extraction Morphology and Relative Pronoun (Davis & Brown, 2011)**

(c) Am-goodi-s **John$_i$**(-hl) **[**Guksk'altamtxw tun e-hl lip'nit ⟨**-hl**⟩$_{i/*j}$**]**$_{\text{FOC}}$
remember-TR[-3.II]=PN John(=CN) [photo DEM PREP=CN SELF-3.SG.III⟨=CN⟩]$_{\text{FOC}}$
⟨**guu-hl**⟩ anoga-s **Sarah$_j$**.
⟨REL=CN⟩ like=PN Sarah.

'John remembers that it is this photo of {himself / *herself} that Sarah likes.'

- **Subordinate Clause as with Properties of Independent Clause: Series II Pronoun**

(d) Am-goodi-s **John$_i$**(-hl) **[**Guksk'altamtxw tun e-hl lip'nit$_{i/*j}$**]**$_{\text{FOC}}$ anoga-**t$_j$**.
remember-TR[-3.II]=PN John(=CN) [photo DEM PREP=CN SELF-3.SG.III]$_{\text{FOC}}$ like-[3SG.II].

'John remembers that it is this photo of {himself / *herself} that she likes.'

- ***Amgoodis* does allow DP/NP Complements**

(e) Amgood-i-s John-hl mi' go'o-hl wilpsiwilaksa.
remember-TR[-3.II]=PN John=CN girl from=CN school.

'John remembers the girl from school.'

Complexities: Long-Distance Movement (?) in Gitksan

- **Perhaps Gitksan relative clauses do not allow reconstruction.**
  - But this predicts that Gitksan lacks raising relative clauses, unlike English, as argued by Sauerland (2000; 2003).
  - It also has consequences for Condition C. Needs more testing.

- **Does Gitksan have real subordinate clauses and successive-cyclic movement?**
  - Needs more testing.

Next Steps

- **Simple clauses**
  - Collect more data with a wider range of lexical items.
- **Complex clauses**
  - Gitksan relativization Structure.
  - Cleft.
  - Cross-check the Condition C data with other groups.
  - Check more lexical items and constructions.
- *lip'nit* as a predicate?

References

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